

UGONNA EZENEKWE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Sociology with Criminology graduate moving into cyber security and IT, with practical experience built through project work rather than coursework alone. Set up and ran a Splunk and Ubuntu lab to triage alerts and analyse network traffic, and completed control audits against NIST CSF, PCI DSS and UK GDPR, producing the gap analysis, risk register and remediation roadmap. Currently finishing the Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate alongside a customer facing role at Co-op, where I resolve problems under time pressure and explain them clearly to people with no technical background. My degree trained me to look at behaviour, process and risk rather than technology alone, and I am now looking for a graduate role or summer internship across security operations, governance and risk, or wider IT.

KEY SKILLS

Professional skill: Report Writing and Documentation, Customer Service, Working Under Pressure, Teamwork and Collaboration, Time Management, Adaptability, Data Collection

Governance, Risk and Compliance: Control Gap Analysis, Risk Assessment and Risk Registers, Governance Documentation, Audit Reporting, Remediation Roadmaps, Third Party Risk

Frameworks and Standards: NIST CSF 2.0, PCI DSS, UK GDPR, ISO/IEC 27001:2022, Cyber Essentials, NIST Incident Response Lifecycle

Security Operations: SIEM Alert Triage and Escalation, Event Monitoring, Log Analysis, Packet Capture Analysis, Incident Documentation, Splunk, Wazuh, Wireshark, Tcpdump

Technical: Linux (Ubuntu), Command Line Administration, VirtualBox, Python, SQL, Excel (Lookups, Pivot Tables), Microsoft Office

Stakeholder and Project Support: Reporting to Senior Managers, Drafting Briefings and Correspondence, Milestone Tracking, Action Management

Certifications: Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate

PROJECTS

Security Control and Compliance Audits | Independent May 2026 – Present

- Conducted end to end internal audits of two simulated organisations in retail and healthcare contexts, assessed against PCI DSS, UK GDPR and NIST CSF, covering asset inventory, control gap identification and risk register development.
- Identified critical gaps including absent least privilege access, unencrypted customer data and no disaster recovery plan, and built a risk register rating threat likelihood and impact across administrative, technical and physical controls.
- Delivered written audit reports and remediation roadmaps presenting prioritised findings to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Home SOC Lab (Splunk / Ubuntu) | Independent May 2026 – Present

- Built and maintained an Ubuntu based security lab running Splunk and tcpdump, provisioning virtual machines, managing packages and resolving boot and configuration failures.
- Triage alerts across simulated brute force, ransomware, phishing and data exfiltration incidents, applying the NIST incident response lifecycle to document detection and containment.
- Analysed captured traffic with Wireshark and tcpdump to identify SYN and ICMP flood DoS activity, tracing half open TCP connections to a single source IP and a misconfigured firewall as root cause, then recommended rate limiting and IDS/IPS deployment.
- Investigated a brute force attack against an administrative account and recommended a strong password policy, multi factor authentication and login attempt limits.

SOC Analyst Simulation Training (SOC Simulator / LetsDefend) | Independent June 2026 – Present

- Completed alert triage across simulated SIEM, XDR and firewall consoles, prioritising by severity and context and correlating events into attack narratives.
- Documented each investigation using structured case report templates, recording findings, evidence and response decisions consistently.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Customer Team Member | Co-op Dec 2025 – Present

- Handled several thousand pounds in daily transactions working accurately at pace through peak trading periods
- First point of contact for customers on the shop floor, resolving queries, complaints, till and payment issues to store procedure and escalating to a duty manager where a case need sign off

Justice Research and Communications Intern | Reimagining Criminal Justice C.I.C. Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Managed a structured stakeholder database of over 50 national and international organisations, keeping records accurate and retrievable for senior staff.
- Produced concise written summaries of complex documents for senior decision makers, distilling dense material into actionable outputs.
- Drafted outreach correspondence to external partner organisations on behalf of senior staff, working to the organisation's sign off requirements, and coordinated research inputs across multiple workstreams to deadline.

EDUCATION

BSc Sociology with Criminology | Middlesex University – First Class